

# AI water consumption.

Posted by u/kalkvesuic • 0 points • 69 comments

Global freshwater consumption is estimated at 3,880,000,000,000 m³. About 70% goes to agriculture, 19% to industry, and 11% to municipalities.

Now, data centers in the USA consume roughly 66 million m³ of water directly. Around 45% of all data centers are in the USA. Let's be generous and assume that all data centers worldwide consume water at the same rate. That comes out to 146.6 million m³, which is a whopping \\*drum noises\\* 0.0037% of global water use.

“““Oh, but you didn't include indirect water consumption!!“““ you say?!? Alright, let's add that too. The indirect water footprint of US data centers is estimated at 800 million m³. Again, let's be generous and scale that globally using the USA standard. After the math, this increases the staggering total of 0.049%. :O

And lemme tell you, this is for **\*\*ALL\*\*** data centers. AI only uses about 14% of those. So yeah, the numbers I gave you are roughly seven times higher than what AI actually consumes.

Sources:

[https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000375724](https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000375724) ,  
[https://www.circleofblue.org/2025/water-energy/data-center-energy-demand-is-putting-pressure-on-u-s-water-supplies/](https://www.circleofblue.org/2025/water-energy/data-center-energy-demand-is-putting-pressure-on-u-s-water-supplies/)  
[https://www.eesi.org/articles/view/data-centers-and-water-consumption](https://www.eesi.org/articles/view/data-centers-and-water-consumption)

## Comments

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><div>u/ThatOneGuyFr0mSch00l • 1 points • 2025-09-04 20:44 UTC</div><div>Also, Google recently released the energy consumption for using Gemini.</div><div>The energy consumption of a Gemini query is equivalent to that of operating a microwave for one second 🤔</div></div> |                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                 |
| <div><div>u/Even-Mode7243 • 1 points • 2025-09-04 15:21 UTC</div><div>I've seen these facilities reduce water pressure in nearby homes to drips. Idk how common this is but it would seem Consumption alone isn't the issue.</div></div>                                            | <div><div>u/kalkvesuic • 2 points • 2025-09-04 15:27 UTC</div><div>Thats a capitalism issue, not a data center issue.</div></div> | <div><div>u/Even-Mode7243 • 1 points • 2025-09-04 15:31 UTC</div><div>I think it's definitely a data center issue since the data center is directly causing the issue, no?</div></div> | <div><div>u/kalkvesuic • 2 points • 2025-09-04 15:36 UTC</div><div>USA&amp;China do not regulate enough and does not care about its citizens, corp will be corp and take advantage of this.</div></div> | <div><div>u/Even-Mode7243 • 1 points • 2025-09-04 15:43 UTC</div><div>The government doesn't regulate plenty of things that aren't problems for citizens.</div><div>You are basically admitting that data centers ARE problems and that the government should be intervening..</div></div> | <div><div>u/kalkvesuic • 2 points • 2025-09-04 15:46 UTC</div><div>So are everything else if things go unregulated.</div></div> |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <div><div>u/Even-Mode7243 • 1 points • 2025-09-04 15:51 UTC</div><div>So the EU has recognized that data centers negatively impact the humans</div></div>                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                 |

that live around them. Something you apparently can't do.

u/kalkvesuic  
• 1 points •  
2025-09-04  
15:54 UTC  
  
"Nuclear  
Energy is  
bad bc of  
chernobly".  
"Planes are  
bad bc of  
9/11."

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**u/Even-Mode7243** • 1 points • 2025-09-04 15:29 UTC

Oh.

**u/Sausagerrito** • 1 points • 2025-09-04 13:00 UTC

These figures are just not true, a quick search shows these data centers use roughly 4-6 billion m3, making up 0.1-0.15%

The daily query traffic is enough water for 1.2m people to drink.

**u/Sausagerrito** • 1 points • 2025-09-04 13:03 UTC

And that's just ai, i wasn't including other data centers.

**u/kalkvesuic** • 2 points • 2025-09-04 13:21 UTC

any source?

**u/Arsenist099** • 3 points • 2025-09-04 07:50 UTC

What can I say

The American cheeseburger needs its sacrifices